Conversation track 1, 3, 4

Esther and Eddie are catching up over coffee.

Esther: So, tell me everything. How's the new job?

Eddie: Really good, actually. Lots of travel.

Esther: How glamorous. **Mind you**, I'd hate living out of a suitcase.

Eddie: It has its moments. Last week I got stuck in Chicago, and...

Esther: Sorry, hang on. That's our coffee. Back in a sec.

Eddie: Thanks. **Anyway, as I was saying**, I slept at the airport.

Esther: Poor you. Airports at night are the worst.

Eddie: Don't get me started. **Speaking of which**, did you ever book Japan?

Esther: Finally, yes! Two weeks in April. I can't wait.

Eddie: Amazing! **Come to think of it**, my cousin's in Osaka. You could stay with her!

Study Notes

I'd hate living out of a suitcase.
Mình thì chịu không nổi cảnh xách vali đi suốt.
"live out of a suitcase" = đi suốt, chỗ nào cũng chỉ ở tạm vài hôm, đồ đạc lúc nào cũng nằm trong vali.
Cách nói tương đương: I'd hate always being on the road.

It has its moments.
Lúc vui, lúc khổ ấy mà.
Ý là không phải lúc nào cũng hay; ở đây Eddie thừa nhận đi công tác nhiều cũng có lúc vất vả.
Cách nói tương đương: It has its ups and downs.

Speak Like a Native track 2

1. Mind you, I'd hate living out of a suitcase.
change: "Mind_you" (d + y → j)
linking: "out_of_a"
strong: "hate", "suitcase"
"Mind you" là một cụm riêng, đọc "main-ju" rồi ngắt nhẹ. Giọng Anh hay giữ t rõ khi nối: "out of a" → "ao-tơ-vơ".

2. Anyway, as I was saying, I slept at the airport.
linking: "as_I"
weak: "was"
strong: "Anyway", "slept", "airport"
"Anyway" tách thành một nhịp, cuối hơi lên giọng để báo "mình kể tiếp đây". "as I was saying" đọc nhanh, thấp: "ơ-zai-wơz-sây-ing".

3. Come to think of it, my cousin's in Osaka.
weak: "to"
linking: "think_of_it"
strong: "cousin's", "Osaka"
Cụm báo một ý vừa nảy ra: đọc nhanh, nhẹ; "think of it" nối thành "thin-kơ-vit". Nhấn thông tin mới: "Osaka".

- Discourse markers (Anyway, Mind you, Speaking of which) là một cụm riêng: đọc liền, rồi ngắt nhẹ trước ý chính.
- "Anyway" hơi lên giọng thường là mình nói tiếp; xuống giọng dứt khoát là muốn dừng chuyện.
- "Mind you" (nhưng mà) chủ yếu là lối nói Anh; người Mỹ hay nói "Then again".
- Giọng Anh (Esther) giữ /j/ trong "new": /nju:/; giọng Mỹ: /nu:/.

Grammar Focus

Mind you / Speaking of which / Come to think of it

Mind you = nhưng mà (thêm ý ngược lại); Speaking of which = nhân nói đến chuyện đó; Come to think of it = giờ nghĩ lại mới nhớ ra.

The hotel was cheap. **Mind you**, the beds were awful.
I need a break. **Speaking of which**, how was Bali?
Come to think of it, I haven't seen Sam all week.

Anyway / As I was saying / Where was I?

Quay lại câu chuyện chính sau khi bị ngắt hoặc lạc đề. "Anyway" còn dùng để đổi chủ đề hoặc kết thúc cuộc trò chuyện.

Sorry about that. **As I was saying**, the plan is simple.
Now, **where was I**? Oh yes, the budget.
Anyway, I'd better get going.

Role Play track 6

A: So, tell me everything. How's the new job?

B: Really good, actually. Lots of travel.

A: How glamorous. Mind you, I'd hate living out of a suitcase.

B: It has its moments. Last week I got stuck in Chicago, and...

A: Sorry, hang on. That's our coffee. Back in a sec.

B: Thanks. _____, I slept at the airport.

A: Poor you. Airports at night are the worst.

B: Don't get me started. _____, did you ever book Japan?

A: Finally, yes! Two weeks in April. I can't wait.

B: Amazing! _____, my cousin's in Osaka. You could stay with her!

Substitution Drill track 7

1. Anyway, as I was saying, I slept at the airport.
   a. So, like I was saying
   b. Anyway, back to my story
   c. Where was I? Oh, right

2. Speaking of which, did you ever book Japan?
   a. Oh, that reminds me
   b. Speaking of travel
   c. On that note

3. Come to think of it, my cousin's in Osaka.
   a. Actually
   b. Now that I think about it
   c. Oh, by the way